

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

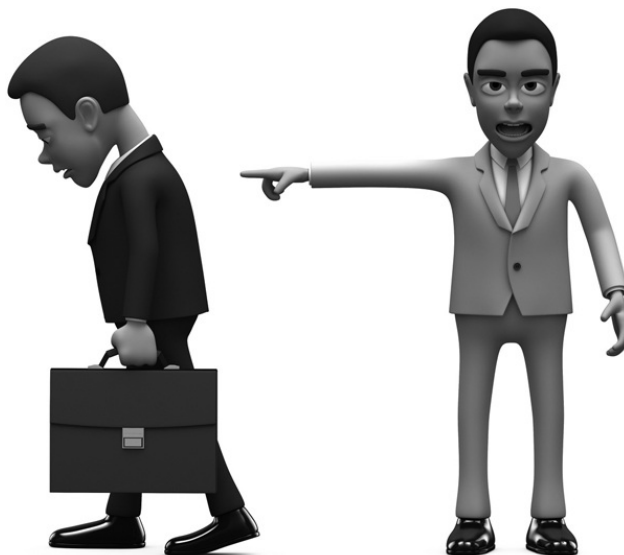
CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Mistakes can happen ... even in management!



Learning Outcome

Describe the reasons or results of events or actions in spoken or written texts, in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What do you think is a common mistake that a manager can make?
- What is the main difference between a good and bad manager?

Can Do Statements

- I can discuss reasons and results of an event or action related to work and jobs.
- I can talk or report about things, actions, events, or people in a work environment.
- I can talk about the mistakes a manager can make.





Let's Explore!

What are the five common mistakes that managers make? What should they not be **caught up in**?

* To "be caught up in" means to be or get involved in something.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Grasping authority

When you begin working in a managerial role, it's natural to want to be involved in all discussions and to feel the need to keep tabs on every move the team makes. Your team needs to know what your expectations are. You need to trust your team and step out of the way. Knowing the most effective way to distribute and complete the work, the team will likely perform well with some autonomy. When a team is provided with the resources and information it requires, it is able to work efficiently without you monitoring everything.

Defining roles

As a manager, your responsibilities include overseeing the work of a team. Having many years experience in their careers, some team members are very knowledgeable. However, by no means should you adopt a laissez-faire attitude or approach in managing them. Adequate feedback, ongoing direction, good morale and motivation are things any good manager has to offer their team. Having outlined roles and responsibilities, you ensure your team understands their duties. Many managers know how to do this, but they fail to fill their staff in on the big picture because they are caught up in the details.

Learning to listen

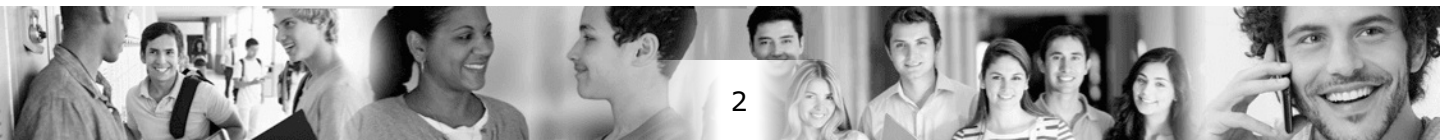
Those managers that are great at giving direction and providing feedback, are often the ones who neglect to ask for their team's ideas and input. Innovative ideas and new perspectives are resources that even junior staff can offer, and by not listening to them, you will miss out. When you launch a new project or consider a new process, hold a team brainstorming session.

Decision making

Productivity in a business environment is impeded by indecisiveness or hesitation. Having gathered all the information you need, make a decision. Avoid procrastinating. When you make a decision take time to do research, or use tools available to you so that you can more easily choose a course of action to take.

Recognition and praise

When feedback is carefully delivered, it brings out the best in your team. Not giving your team praise when they succeed will make them feel undervalued. Praise is a simple way to make them feel appreciated. Also, praising the group or individuals during a meeting can really have a positive impact. Being committed to learning from your mistakes, you'll become more relaxed and confident in your role as manager.





Let's Practice!

Managers encounter many pitfalls*.

*"pitfalls" are traps or hazards.

Instructions: Use the options from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences. There are two options that you do not need to use. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

Not giving your team praise when they succeed / because of their experience /
Being learning / Being committed to learning / Having many years experience in
her career / Knowing the most effective way to complete the work /
the big picture because

1. _____, the team will likely perform well with some autonomy.
2. _____, Catherine was very knowledgeable.
3. Many managers know how to do this, but they fail to fill their staff in on _____
they are caught up in the details.
4. _____, will make them feel undervalued.
5. _____ from your mistakes, you'll become more relaxed and confident
in your role as manager.



Let's Practice!

The mistakes managers make.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Circle the incorrect words. Write the correct words above them. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Win you begin in a managerial role, it's natural to want to feel the need to keep tabs on every move the team makes.
2. When you had launched a new project or consider a new process, hold a team brainstorming session.
3. Whin you do a decision, take time to do research, or use tools available to you so that you can more easily choose a course of action to take.
4. We were make our schedule when the lawyers walks in.
5. When feedback is carefully delivered, it bringing the best in your team.





Extension Activity

Write about an experience with a bad manager.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Brainstorm mistakes you feel a bad manager often makes.
- Change partners and compare.
- Write a story about a personal experience with a bad manager (a former teacher, a coach ...).
- Make your story about 200 words long.
- How was the manager ineffective? What mistakes did they make?
- Share stories with a partner.
- Compare the experiences to the "common mistakes managers make" in the lesson dialogue and look for similarities.



Target Words

- **to keep tabs** (expression): to watch someone or something carefully to check what they are doing
e.g. It's natural to want to try to be involved in all discussions and to feel the need to keep tabs on every move the team makes.
- **productivity** (noun): the rate at which something is produced in relation to the work, time, and money needed to produce them
e.g. Indecisiveness or hesitation can significantly impede productivity in a business environment.
- **to outline** (verb): to give the main points but not the details
Example: Having outlined roles and responsibilities, you ensure your team understands their duties.
- **the big picture** (expression): the situation considered as a whole
e.g. They fail to fill their staff in on the big picture because they are caught up in the details.
- **input** (noun): ideas that you put into a job or activity in order to help it succeed
e.g. Those managers that are great at giving direction and providing feedback, are often the ones who neglect to ask for their team's ideas and input.
- **indecisiveness** (noun): the state of being unable to make a choice
e.g. Productivity in a business environment is impeded by indecisiveness or hesitation.
- **hesitation** (noun): pausing before doing something, especially when you are not certain about something
e.g. Without hesitation the manager gave the team some extra time to complete the project.
- **to impede** (verb): to make it difficult for someone or something to make progress
e.g. That impeded our progress.
- **ongoing** (adjective): continuing
e.g. Adequate feedback, ongoing direction, and good morale and motivation are things any good manager has to offer their team.
- **to procrastinate** (verb): to delay doing something that you ought to do, usually because you do not want to do it
e.g. Having gathered all the information you need, make a decision and avoid procrastinating.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I brainstorm ideas about what makes a bad manager.

☐ ☐

I share my ideas with others.

☐ ☐

I write about a personal experience with a bad manager and share stories with a partner.

☐ ☐

I compare the stories to the "common mistakes managers make."

☐ ☐



Learning Points

Reason Clauses: Using a Participle Clause and *Because*

There are different ways to construct a sentence with a reason clause. You should try to vary the way you construct sentences to make your English appear more dynamic.

1. You can use a conjunction like *because*.

For example:

*I made mistakes **because** I was tired.*

*The team succeeded **because** she was the manager.*

1. **Participle clauses** enable you to share information in a more economical way.

Participle clauses can be formed with:

the **present participle** (-ing form of the verb)

Example: **Being** tired, I made mistakes.

(It means that because the speaker was tired, mistakes were made.)

1. **Past participle**

This structure has a passive meaning.

Example: **Yelled at** loudly, the dog sat down.

(It means that someone was yelling at the dog.)

To emphasize that one action took place before another, we can use a **perfect participle** (having + past participle).

Example: **Having lost** my passport, I have to apply for a new one.

*The restaurant **having closed**, there was nowhere to eat.*

Examples:

- *Crowds were waiting at the airport, hoping to see the CEO arrive.*
- *Not feeling very well, James decided to leave for the day.*
- *Being rather busy, I completely forgot the time.*
- *Many managers take this step, but neglect to give their staff a sense of the big picture because they are caught up with the details.*
- *Having outlined roles and responsibilities, you ensure that your team understands their duties.*



Learning Points

When-Clauses to Express Time

You use an **adverbial clause** of time with a conjunction.

To talk about a complete action, you use the conjunction **when** to connect the time clause to the rest of the sentence.

For example:

When I arrived, the meeting was over.

We were discussing the issue **when** the manager walked in.

When can also mean "every time".

Example:

When you go to see her, she is always busy.

(In this case, **when** means that she is busy every time someone visits her.)

I walk to the office **when** it's nice out.

(**When** means that the speaker walks to the office every time it's nice out.)

Examples:

- *When a team is provided with the resources and information it requires, it is able to work efficiently without you monitoring everything.*
- *When you begin working in a managerial role, it's natural to want to try to be involved in all discussions and to feel the need to keep tabs on every move the team makes.*

